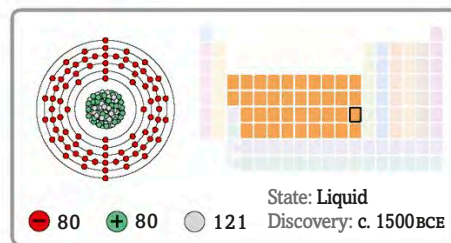


80  
**Hg**

# Mercury



## Forms

*This bright red mineral is the main ore of mercury used today.*

Cinnabar



*The "ribbed" effect is due to mercury's extremely high density.*

*Liquid form of pure mercury*

*This metal melts at  $-39^{\circ}\text{C}$  ( $-38^{\circ}\text{F}$ ).*

Solid mercury is soft enough to be **cut with a knife.**

**Mercury is the only metal that is liquid at room temperature.** Along with water, it is one of the few liquids found naturally on Earth's surface. **Pure mercury** forms around volcanoes where the heat separates it from its minerals, such as **cinnabar**. This red mineral has been

used for many centuries: ancient Romans roasted cinnabar to release a liquid they called *hydrargyrum*, meaning "silver water". This was the element mercury. It was later known as quicksilver because of how fast it flowed as a stream of liquid. This metal is very poisonous: